

your journey. In a world that loves extremes, finding your place in the middle is radical. And the radical middle is at the core of values-based spending.

With everything our brains have to process at any given moment, especially as we learn new topics, sometimes it is easier to be told what to think. It's why we start learning a skill with just one teacher. We're naturally attracted to the "all-or-nothing" methods because absolute right and wrong choices are easier to process.

The radical middle isn't the rejection of extremes, it's holding the tension between them. It refuses to believe that there are only two sides and looks for the middle ground or a third option. It forces creativity, empathy, and forgiveness in a world that says "My way or the highway." When you reject the either/or binary and replace it with both/and, you open yourself up to living a life that's fully your own, not one that someone else has designed for you.

Throughout the rest of this book, you'll learn how to master the skill of spending and how to find your radical middle when your situation may be different from ours. We'll dive deeper into the mindset shifts and action steps you can take to find what you love, say no to what you don't, and, ultimately, not go broke. And we've divided the book into those aptly named sections.

In part 1, we'll talk about how to buy what you love. You'll learn how to identify what you love spending on, the things money can't buy, and how to find the radical middle between the two. One of the foundational sub-skills to values-based spending is healthy communication . . . with yourself. We'll go in depth on where to focus your attention and how to speak to yourself when you're making spending decisions, and what to do when you make a decision you're not proud of. We'll also cover what to do when decision-making isn't simple, like when you're in a season of life that doesn't allow for certain things, or how to prioritize your values when you can't afford them all.

In part 2, we'll focus on how to say no. This is something most books stop short of or never touch on, but we're devoting three whole chapters to it. We'll start by covering why you can't stop spending and why that's intentional. We'll talk about dopamine as a factor in making shopping addictive, how to reset your dopamine receptors, and the psychology behind